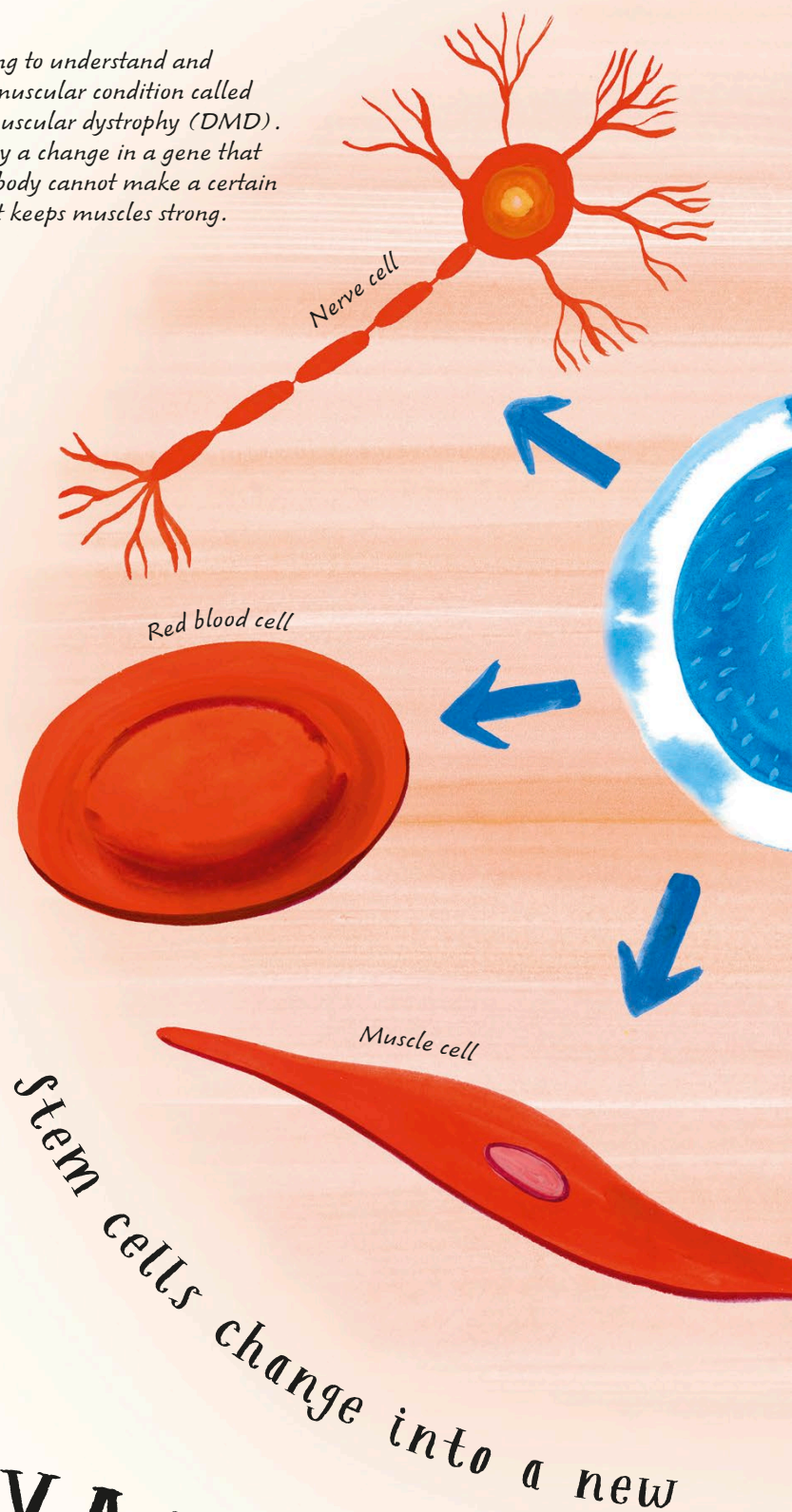




Mayana is trying to understand and treat a neuromuscular condition called Duchenne muscular dystrophy (DMD). It's caused by a change in a gene that means the body cannot make a certain protein that keeps muscles strong.

What do you want to be when you grow up? Mayana Zatz found this impossible to answer! She wanted to be a doctor so she could help people, but also a scientist so she could learn more about why people become sick in the first place.

Mayana found a way to be both. As a specialist in human genetics, she conducts research *and* works with patients. One of her first projects was investigating the causes of neuromuscular conditions, which affect nerves and muscles.



MAYANA ZATZ
Israeli-born Brazilian geneticist
1947-present